LAST EXIT ON 285

ACTION THRILLER / FEATURE FILM

Written by Kelly R. Tenney



One night. Her daughter. No safe way home.

The logline

An ex-Army MP driving Atlanta’s Perimeter for rideshare money picks up a bookkeeper fleeing a trafficking ring. When the man running it kidnaps her daughter, she must confront the trauma that ended her military career and get them out before a dawn shipment leaves the city.

A mother’s worst night becomes the fight she can no longer avoid.



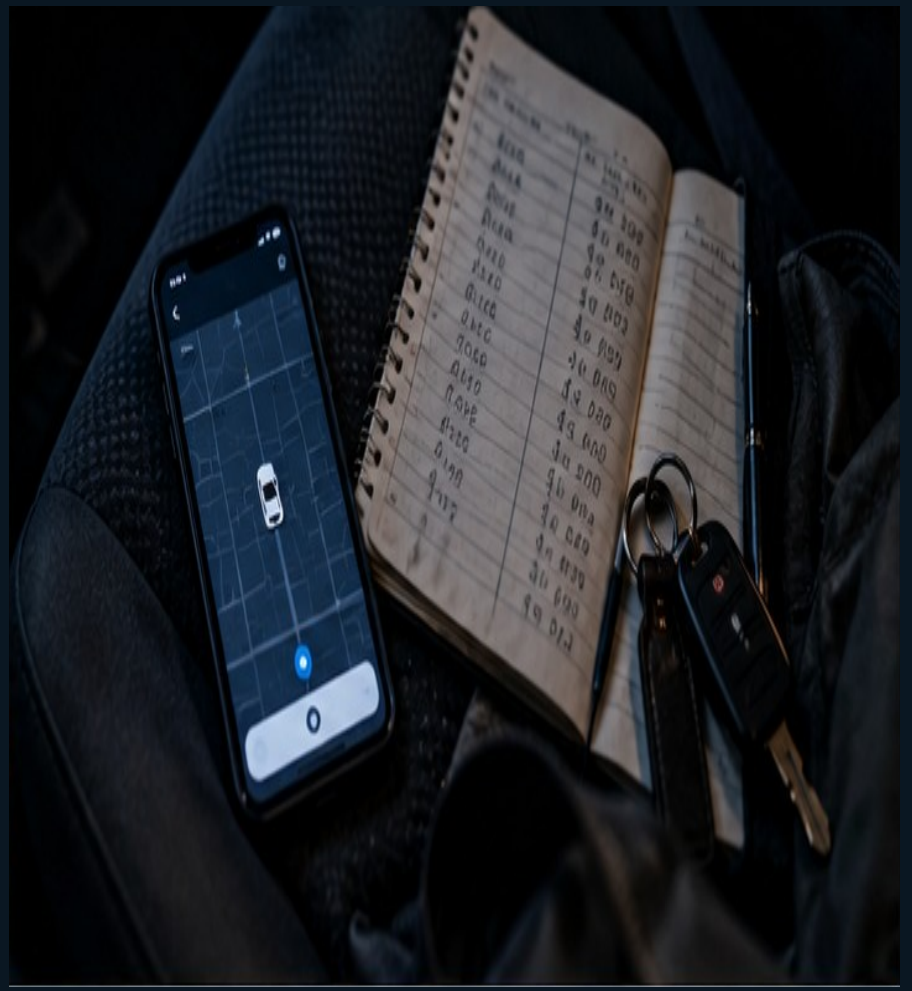
The hook

The getaway driver never agreed to the job

A familiar rideshare pickup becomes a trap arranged by her own ex-husband.

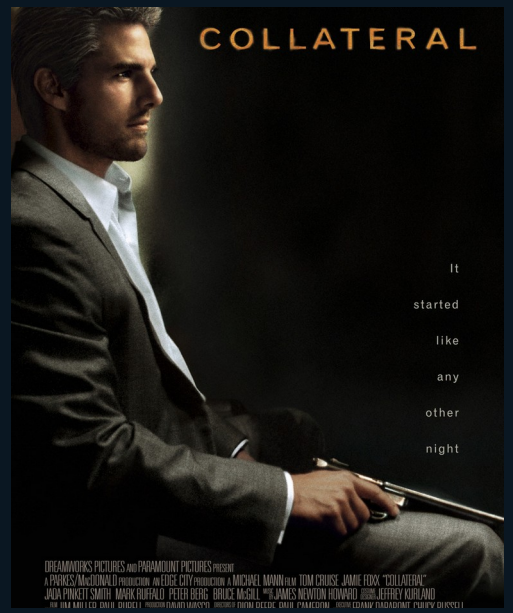
I-285 keeps bringing her back around. Roadwork, freight traffic and a shared location turn the city into a moving cage.

Her daughter helps engineer the escape. Their survival depends on learning to trust each other.



Tone & comparables

Grounded suspense. Moral pressure. Intimate family stakes.



COLLATERAL

A working driver pulled into an urban criminal night.



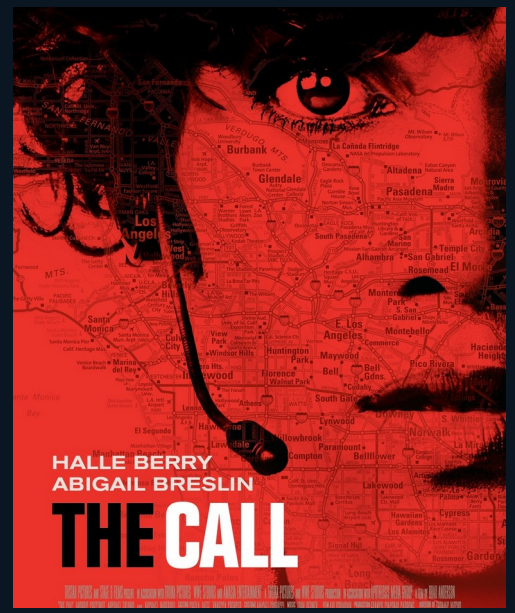
KIDNAP

A mother’s relentless pursuit of her child.



BREAKING IN

A resourceful woman fights through a fortified trap.



THE CALL

Urgent phone contact turns fear into tactical action.

Renee Carter

38 / EX-ARMY MP / RIDESHARE DRIVER

She can read a road. She struggles to read her daughter.

Disciplined, observant and dryly funny. She turns constant vigilance into a way of life.

GOAL **Bring Kayla home before the truck leaves.**

CONFLICT Using her training means facing the civilian death that made her put down her weapon.



Roman



55 / FREIGHT OPERATOR / ANTAGONIST

He puts a price on everyone

A cardigan, reading glasses and an ordinary office conceal a man who treats human lives as inventory.

He uses Victor’s debt to recruit Renee’s car, then takes Kayla as collateral.

Renee breaks his control by refusing the choices he offers her.

The people caught in the loop

KAYLA CARTER, 15

Renee’s artistic, technically capable daughter. Her escape skills challenge her mother’s need for control.

MIA PRICE, 19

A captive who keeps fighting. She and Kayla turn observation into an escape plan.

MARCUS DOYLE, 45

A trusted family friend becomes a captor. Small mercies cannot undo his choices.

JONAH PRICE, 34

The bookkeeper steals a ledger to save his sister, then must confess his own complicity.

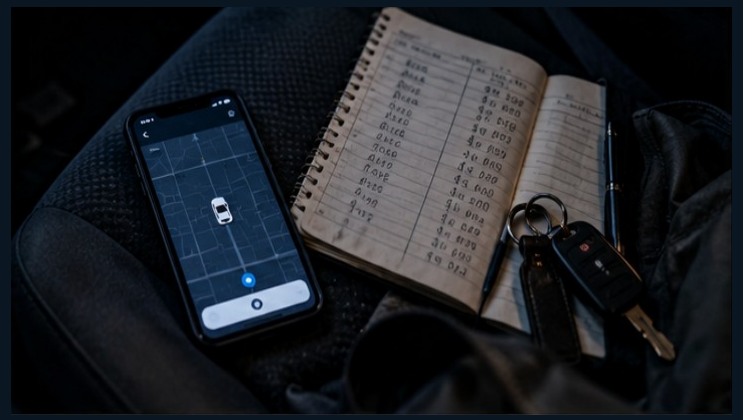
VICTOR CARTER, 42

Kayla’s charming father sells Renee’s evening to settle gambling debt, then faces the cost.

DENISE HOLLOWAY, 52

Renee’s former sergeant, now with GBI. An old trust becomes the route to help.

One night on the Perimeter







ACT I / THE PICKUP

Renee needs tuition money. Her ex-husband secretly offers her car as a courier vehicle. Jonah climbs in carrying cash and a ledger that exposes a trafficking ring.

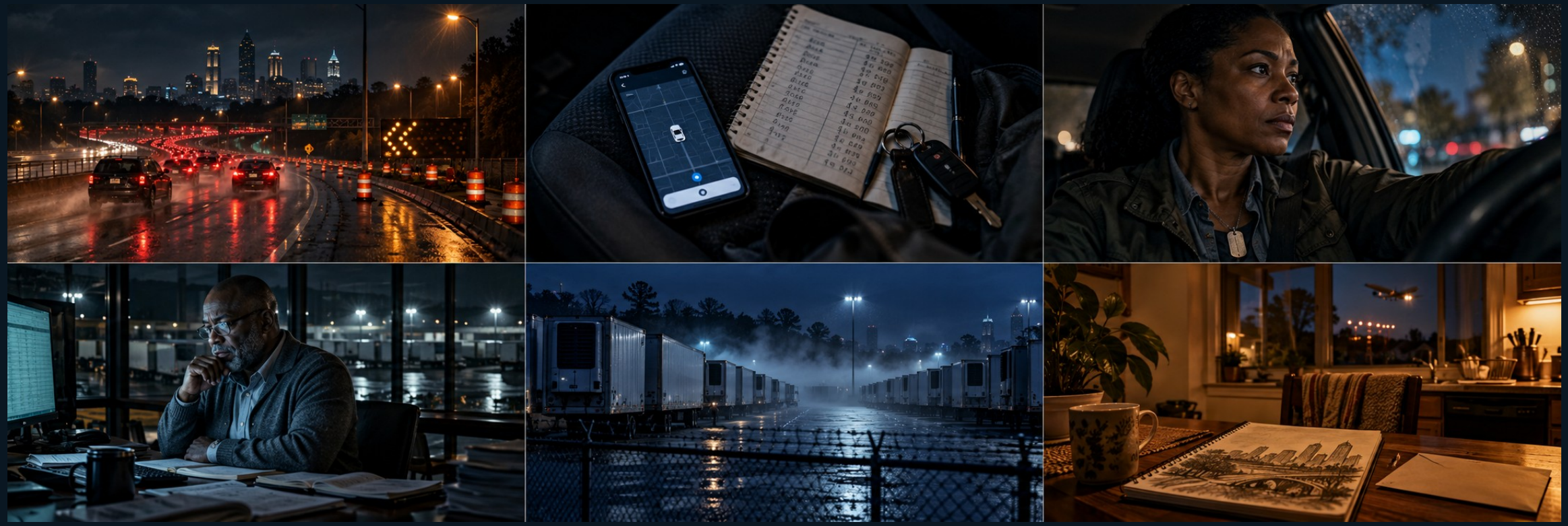
ACT II / THE BETRAYAL

Pursuers track the Accord, and Marcus takes Kayla. Renee and Jonah confront what they have avoided while Kayla and the captives build their own escape.

ACT III / THE EXIT

At the depot, Renee signals GBI and stops the departing truck. Mother and daughter survive, but Victor disappears. At home, Renee finally makes room for Kayla’s future.

Visual style

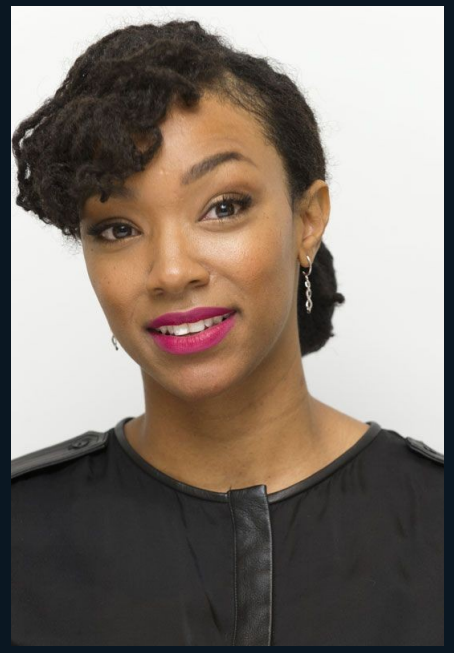


STEEL BLUE **CHARCOAL** **AMBER** **PAPER WHITE**

Practical light. Windshield reflections. Cold freight steel. A warm kitchen at the end of the night.

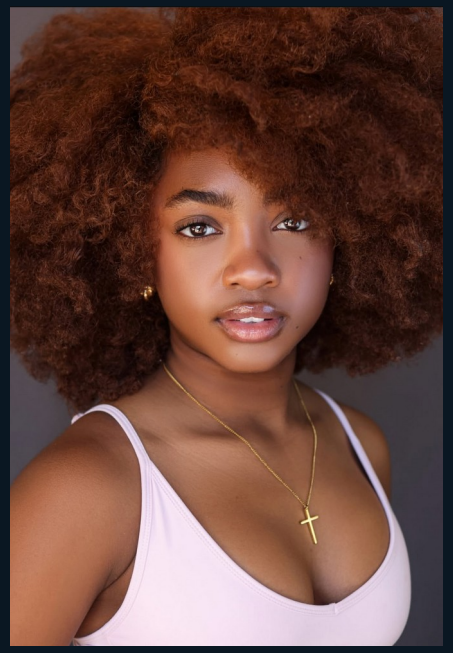
Casting wishlist

Creative references only. No cast attached.



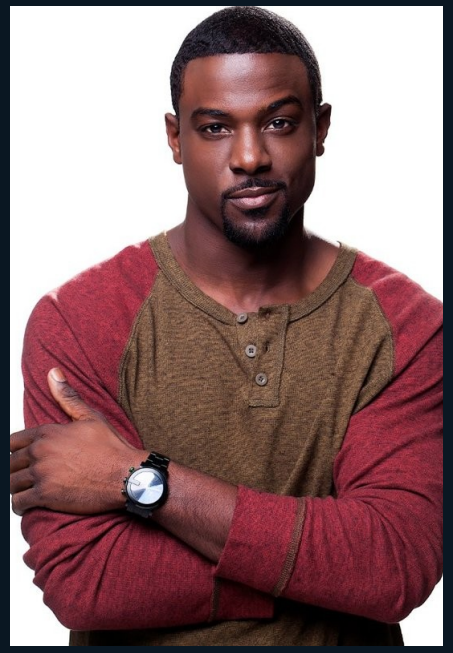
Sonequa Martin-Green

RENEE



Leah Sava Jeffries

KAYLA



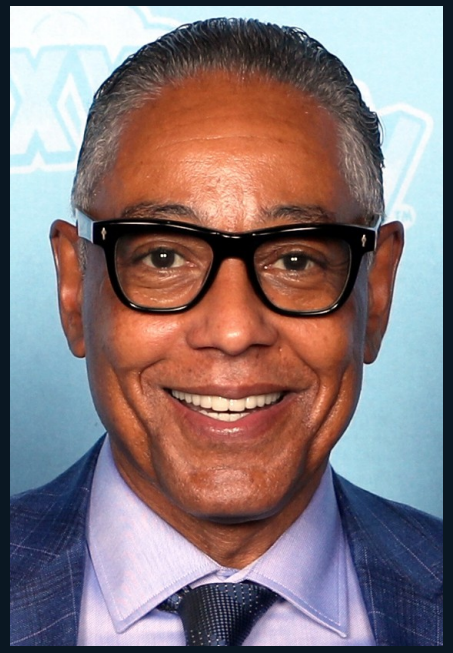
Lance Gross

VICTOR



Mamoudou Athie

JONAH



Giancarlo Esposito

ROMAN

Proposed platform fit: BET+

01 A Black mother and daughter drive both the suspense and the emotional resolution.

02 An immediate genre promise: one ride, a family betrayal, a rescue before dawn.

03 Atlanta’s working lives and family relationships give the action a specific world.

04 Renee offers a substantial lead role with vulnerability, dry humor and physical action.

05 A small core ensemble and recurring locations support focused production planning.



Materials & next steps

AVAILABLE

Third-draft screenplay
Landscape key art
12-slide pitch deck

NEXT

01 Complete continuity and action polish

02 Build the stunt budget and night schedule

03 Pursue director and lead attachments

04 Prepare financing and buyer outreach

Seeking producing and packaging partners

Kelly R. Tenney / NCCA Entertainment